



The double-page spread - The way the media through re-presentation construct versions of reality.

Newspapers are not a **window on the world**; the gatekeepers of the newspaper will select, construct and mediate the news, thereby re-presenting a version of reality to suit their readers and the ideology of the newspaper.

- The newspaper has made decisions regarding how the story will be **mediated** and what the focus will be. In the case of this double-page spread, the focus of the representation is an interpretation of the deal for their readers, this presents a positive representation of the government and in particular, the Prime Minister and his relationship with the EU. This framing of the story is to be expected from a left-wing publication.
- The use of the direct quotations, the informal image of Keir Starmer and Ursula von de Leyen and the clear layout explaining the benefits of the deal for ordinary people, **personalises** the story by making it about the experiences of individuals rather than a complicated political process involving issues distanced from the newspaper's readers. This technique is used by the news media to help audiences build **emotional engagement** with more complex political stories and is a technique particularly used by tabloid newspapers.
- A similar technique is used in including the opinion pieces which strike a personal tone and reinforce the values and beliefs of the newspaper and the expectations of the readers. Here, the story is re-presented through the eyes of two left-wing voices, a government minister and a journalist offering their personal interpretations. This is particularly the case with the piece by Kevin Maguire which is more forthright in its condemnation of the Brexit process and the Conservative Party.
- The **language and mode of address** used also contributes to the construction of representations, the use of positive language commending the deal will persuade the reader of its importance to them. The emotive and declamatory language in Kevin Maguire's opinion piece depicts a negative representation of '*Brextremists*' accusing them of '*inflicting unprecedented national self-harm*'. The language of David Lammy's piece is more measured, addressing the reader directly in a reassuring tone and promising '*increased security and prosperity*'.

Theoretical perspectives

Representation - Stuart Hall

- Representations in the newspaper are constructed through recognisable signs and codes, for example in this case, codes of gesture and expression. Codes of clothing also indicate power and standing in society and reinforce the important roles of Keir Starmer and Ursula von de Leyen. In the image of David Beckham selected by the newspaper, he is dressed formally to convey the sense of occasion in meeting the King, audiences recognise these codes and interpret their meaning.
- The *Daily Mirror* pages use **stereotypical representations** of the PM and other members of the government to convey the newspaper's left-wing viewpoint. Meaning is conveyed whereby the readers expect the Labour government to be more concerned with ordinary people. In the newspaper, **subordinate groups** are represented as being important and the newspaper takes its role of speaking back to those in power and advocating the concerns of its readers seriously.